INCH-POUND

A-A-50043A
March 12, 1991
SUPERSEDING
A-A-50043
February 22, 1983

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

WARMER, FOOD, PORTABLE, INFRARED

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to type I of MIL-F-43883.

1. CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Classification. This commercial item description covers a portable, infrared food warmer.

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

2.1 Design and construction. The warmer shall be designed to keep cooked foods placed in the pan at a serving temperature of 140°F in an ambient temperature of 72°F. The warmer shall be a portable, counter-top unit consisting of a heat unit(s), reflector(s), holding pan, rack, frame, and an ON-OFF switch(es). Temperature shall be controlled by adjusting the height of the heat unit(s) or by varying the input power with an infinite control switch. Parts requiring replacement shall be readily accessible without special tools.

2.2 Electrical characteristics. The food warmer shall be rated for operation on 115 volts, 60 Hertz, single phase power source, and shall be equipped with a 6-foot long, UL listed, three-conductor cord with a NEMA 5-15P plug.

2.3 Heat unit. The heat unit(s) shall utilize two standard commercial 250 watt infrared heat lamps or a tubular infrared heating element, pyrex or alloy sheathed, rated at 500 watts. Reflector(s) shall be used for optimum heat utilization. Warmers with adjustable height heat units shall have provisions for holding the frame firmly at any height within the adjustment range. The projected heating area at lowest setting for height shall cover all contents in a nominal 20 inch by 12 inch (full size) food service pan.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any other data which may improve this document should be sent by letter to: Commander, U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: STRNC-WEE, Natick, MA 01760-5018.

AMSC N/A FSC 7310

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2.4 Holding pan. The holding pan shall be a nominal 20 inch by 12 inch (full size) food service pan, depth shall be no less than 2.5 inches, thickness shall be no less than 20 gage, and conform with CID A-A-50179, Pans, Food Serving.

2.5 Rack. The pan shall have a removable rack designed to support the contents placed in the pan. The rack shall be fabricated from stainless steel and shall cover the entire bottom of the pan, providing clearance for food particles between the rack and bottom of the pan.

2.6 Frame. The warmer shall be open on all sides to allow removal of warmed product without removing the pan. The base of the frame shall be so designed and constructed that it will provide a stable support for the warmer when operated on a tabletop or countertop. The pan shall be supported in such a manner that the pan bottom does not contact the tabletop or countertop.

2.7 On-off switch. The warmer shall have an on-off switch(es) to activate the heat unit. The switch(es) shall be visible and accessible to the attendent and located so as to prevent the attendent from contacting the reflector in normal operation.

2.8 Data name plate (Government unique requirement (see 5.5)). The food warmer shall be furnished with a data name plate in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-STD-130 except the requirements for; (a) Methods of applying, (b) Identification tags, (c) Information not required, and (d) Optional marking information shall not apply. The data name plate shall be made of minimum 20 gauge corrosion resisting metal, and attached to the food warmer by rivets, screws, or by welding, in such a manner as to meet the applicable National Sanitation Foundation requirements for this equipment. The plate shall bear the following information which shall be stamped, engraved, or applied by photosensitive means:

National Stock Number
Procurement Instrument Identification Number
Specification Data
Manufacturer's Name, Address, and Telephone Number
Supplier's Name, Address, and Telephone Number (List only if different from Manufacturer)
Manufacturer's Model Number
Government Approved Manual Number (see 5.2)

Each plate shall be placed so as to be readily visible to the operator during normal operation and use, and so as to not adversely affect the life or utility of the food warmer.

2.9 Standards compliance. The food warmer shall comply with the requirements of the National Sanitation Foundation Standard No. 4 and Underwriters Laboratories Standard No. 197. Plugs shall comply with the applicable requirements of the National Electrical Manufacturers Association (NEMA) Standard WD1.

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2.10 Workmanship. The finished food warmers shall be clean and shall not contain any burrs, slivers, breaks, sharp corners, sharp edges, deformities, dents or rough die or grind marks. Welds shall be sound, smooth and free from pits, fractures, burn-through, or fissures. Bolt holes and rivet holes shall be accurately punched or drilled and shall have burrs removed. All bolts, nuts and screws shall be drawn tight. Rivets shall be tightly driven and fully peened. Electrical wiring shall be provided with adequate slack to relieve strain, and the wiring shall not be abraded, poorly joined, or loose at terminals.

3. QUALITY ASSURANCE

3.1 Certification. The contractor shall certify, and maintain objective quality evidence, that the product offered meets this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

3.2 Responsiblity for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all examination, and test requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the examination and tests deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

3.3 Examination. The end item shall be examined for the defect listed in table II. The sample size shall be as indicated in table I. The sample unit shall be one food warmer.

TABLE I. Sampling plan for end item examination

Lot size (warmers)	Sample size	Accept No.	Reject No.
2-50	5	0	1
51-150	20	1	2
151-280	32	2	3
281-500	50	3	4
501-1200	80	5	6

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TABLE II. Classification of defects

Examine	Defect
Workmanship	Dirty Any rough or sharp edges, scratches, burrs, slivers, breaks, sharp corners, deformities, dents, rough die or grind marks
Design and construction	Not designed as specified Maintenance access not provided
ON-OFF switch	Missing. Not accessible and not visible to operator Not located to prevent direct contact with bulb
Bulbs	Missing, not infra-red Not 250-watts
Power supply cord and plug	Not three-wire grounding type cord Not three-prong grounding plug Not 6-foot long
Marking	Missing, not permanent, not legible, marking not as specified

3.4 Testing. One representative production unit shall be functional tested. Connect the food warmer to the power source. Place "ON-OFF" switch in the "ON" position. Check to assure infra-red bulbs or heating elements are operating, and a serving temperature of 140°F in an ambient temperature of 72°F is maintained. Failure of the unit to maintain the specified temperature shall constitute rejection of the lot.

3.5 Compliance. Prior to commencing production, the supplier shall submit satisfactory evidence to the contracting officer or his authorized representative that the food warmers he proposes to supply under this specification meet the applicable requirements of UL No. 197 and NSF No. 4 as follows:

3.5.1 UL. Acceptable evidence of meeting the requirements of UL shall be the UL label, a UL listing mark, or a certified test report from a recognized independent testing laboratory, acceptable to the Government, indicating that the food warmers have been tested and conform to UL No. 197.

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3.5.2 NSF. Acceptable evidence of meeting the requirements of NSF shall be:

(1) A listing in the current edition of the NSF "Listing of Food Service Equipment" or display of the NSF seal on the finished food warmer, or

(2) A certification for the food warmers issued by NSF under their special one-time contract evaluation/certification service, or

(3) A certified test report from a recognized independent testing laboratory acceptable to the medical department of the service for which the food warmers are being procured, indicating that the food warmers have been tested and conform to NSF Standard No. 4.

3.6 Regulatory requirements. In accordance with section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Government's policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing suppliers' employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable. The term "recovered materials" means materials which have been collected or recovered from solid waste and reprocessed to become a source of raw materials as opposed to virgin raw materials. None of the above shall be interpreted to mean that the use of used or rebuilt products are allowed under this commercial item description unless otherwise specified.

3.7 Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch/pound units, provided they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of FED-STD-376, and all other requirements of this commercial item description are met.

4. PACKAGING

4.1 Packaging and Packing. Packaging and packing shall be commercial or export as specified (see 5.2).

4.2 Commercial packaging and packing. The food warmers shall be packaged, packed and unitized in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

4.3 Export packaging and packing.

4.3.1 Export packaging. Each food warmer shall be cleaned, preserved and cushioned to protect against corrosion, deterioration, and physical damage during shipment and storage.

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4.3.2 Export packing. Each food warmer shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, grade V3c, V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed, waterproofed, and reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape in accordance with PPP-B-636.

4.4 Palletization. When specified (see 5.2), shipping containers shall be palletized in accordance with MIL-STD-147.

4.5 Marking (commercial and export). Marking of unit packs, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5. NOTES

5.1 Intended use. The food warmer is intended for use in military dining facilities to keep cooked food at the proper serving temperature.

5.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. Government approved manual number to be included on the data name plate when manuals are purchased under the contract (see 2.9).
c. Type of packaging and packing required (see 4.1).
d. When palletization of shipping containers is required (see 4.4).

5.3 Supersession data. The type II, 220 volt warmer previously covered by this Commercial Item Description is available from Military Specification MIL-F-43883, Food Warmer, Infra-Red, Electric.

5.4 Sources of documents.

5.4.1 Sources of nongovernment association documents.

UL Standard No. 197 - Commercial Electric Cooking Appliances, is available from:

Underwriters Laboratories, Inc. (UL)
333 Pfingsten Road
Northbrook, IL 60062

NSF Standard No. 4 - Commercial Cooking and Hot Food Storage Equipment, is available from:

National Sanitation Foundation (NSF)
3475 Plymouth Road
P.O. Box 1468
Ann Arbor, MI 48106

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Standard WD1 - General Purpose Wiring Devices and NEMA 5-15P plugs, are available from:

National Electrical Manufacturers Association (NEMA)
2101 L Street, N.W.
Washington, DC 20037

ASTM D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging, is available from:

The American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM)
1916 Race Street
Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187

National Motor Freight Classification, is available from:

The American Trucking Association, Inc.
Traffic Department
1616 P Street
N.W., Washington, DC 20036

Uniform Freight Classification, is available from:

The Uniform Classification Committee
Room 1106
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

5.4.2 Sources of governmental documents. Copies of Military and Federal documents are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Bldg. 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

5.5 Government unique requirements. Whenever "(Government unique requirement)" is included in the title of a paragraph under "salient characteristics," it is meant that the requirement is something that is not normally offered to the commercial marketplace by the manufacturer.

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 99

Review Activities

Army - MD, TS
Air Force - 84, 50
DLA - GS

User Activity

Navy - CG, MC

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project 7310-0726

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